

The Parish of Moville

St Pius X, Moville St Mary's, Ballybrack

St Columba's, Ballinacrae St Joseph's Oratory, Shrove



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CALENDAR FOR THE WEEK AHEAD

Sunday 13th The Christian community must be seen to be one of forgiveness and mercy. If the Lord is compassion and love, slow to anger and rich in mercy, who are we to be otherwise? We need to be conscious of our own weaknesses and failures so that we may not judge others. We cannot pray the Lord's Prayer with unforgiving hearts.

Monday 14th The Exaltation of the Holy Cross. This feast celebrates the Cross both as the instrument of Christ's victory over sin in his passing to the Father's glory and as the means of our salvation.

Tuesday 15th Our Lady of Sorrows. Mary stood by the Cross in solidarity with her Son in his passion, uniting her sufferings with his and sharing in his offering to the Father.

Wednesday 16th St Cornelius and St Cyprian. Cornelius became Pope in 251 and died in exile as a martyr in 253. Cyprian, bishop of Carthage, a very influential and revered figure in North Africa, died as a martyr in 258.

Thursday 17th St Robert Bellarmine (1542-1621), Jesuit, bishop, cardinal, and Doctor of the Church, who was deeply involved in the theological controversies of his time. Patron of catechists.

Friday 18th First Anniversary Mass for Fr. Michael Keaveney at 10am.

Saturday 19th St Januarius, bishop, who was martyred with six companions in Naples in 305.

Sunday 20th 11.30am Mass will be celebrated in Ballybrack. Reader at this Mass will be Gerry McQuillan

Mass this week in St Pius X: Monday to Friday 10am. Saturday 6.30pm; Sunday 10am. **Confessions** in St. Pius X Church: Saturday 5.45pm to 6.15pm. **The Rosary and the Divine Mercy Chaplet** will be recited in St. Pius X Church, Moville, at 7.30pm every day, from Sunday – Friday. **Adoration of the Blessed Sacrament** on Monday, 2-9pm; Wednesday, 6-9pm.

We offer our **sympathy** to the families and friends of Michael Gill, Buncrana who died recently. May he rest in peace.

Safeguarding If you have any concerns with regards to Safeguarding children or adults, please contact Marie O'Kane, The Diocesan Designated Liaison Person at 00447596500793 or dlp@derrydiocese.org. Local Safeguarding Representatives are Mary McGranaghan and Brídín Hannaway

Information Evening for Parents

All parents of children who are presenting for the sacraments of Holy Communion and Confirmation in 2027 are asked to attend an information evening in Scoil Eoghain on 23rd of September beginning at 7.30pm sharp. The evening is being facilitated by Thornhill Ministries, and it is essential that each child is represented because Registration Forms will be given out at that meeting.

Thank you for your generous financial support to the parish in the past week, which amounted to €3304. Next weekend there is a collection for **Retired Priests**, therefore there are two envelopes in your box.

Prayer for Vocations: In today's gospel Jesus teaches a powerful lesson on forgiveness. We pray for the men called to priesthood that, as they celebrate the Sacrament of Reconciliation with their people, they will help them to know and experience the Lord who "...is compassion and love, slow to anger, and rich in mercy." (Responsorial Psalm). We pray to the Lord.

Derry Diocese is renewing and developing its **Diocesan Adoration** Lay Committee in order to increase the practice of Eucharistic Adoration in parishes throughout the diocese. You are welcome to attend an Information Meeting on Wednesday 30 September at 8.00pm, in The Drummond Hotel, Ballykelly. Registration and light refreshments from 7.30pm.

If interested in a ten-week introduction to **Irish** course or if you wish to continue the intermediate Irish course, contact Gerrysona123@yahoo.ie or on Facebook messenger.

Moville Tidy Town Committee is holding the **annual beach clean-up** on Saturday 19 September at 10am. Meet at the Shore Car Park.

Set Dancing in Malin Head Community Centre every Thursday at 8pm. (€5). Beginners at 7.30pm.

Spraoi agus Spórt has a range of activities for Children and Families. Contact Unit 6, SuperValu, Carndonagh or visit spraoiagusport.ie.

The **Columban Young Adults** (aged 18 – 30) will have a Holy Hour and meditation on Thursday 17 September at 7pm in Our Lady of Lourdes Church, Steelstown, delivered by Fr Declan McGeehan followed by Benediction and refreshments. They are looking for new members so please attend and bring a friend.

Carrowmena Community Centre (9367061) All-age social club, The Tuesday Club, resumes on Tuesday 15 September at 2pm with a range of activities or simply a chat and make new friends. All welcome. Cost is €5, including afternoon tea. A wide variety of courses is planned for the autumn. Contact the Centre for more information and to book.

Greencastle Community Centre (9381054) info@greencastlecentre.ie UnScripted after-school youth drama project starts Tuesday 22 September at 4pm (food and transport provided). Inish Tennis on Monday 14 September. Call 0832054348 for details. Indoor Bowls on Tuesday 22 September at 11am. Musical Memories on Monday 5 October 11.30am.

Concert in Glencrow Hall on Friday 18 September at 8pm. Tickets €10 which are available at Moville Men's Shed, Glencrow Hall or pay at the door.

As the diocese and parishes prepare to celebrate the joyous occasion of the **Installation of Bishop Michael Router** as Bishop of Derry on Sunday 20 September, a Triduum of Masses will be celebrated in parishes throughout the diocese. In our parish, these Masses will be celebrated in St Pius X Church on Friday 18 September at 10am, Saturday 19 September at 6.30pm and Sunday 20 September at 10am. All are welcome to attend as we come together as God's people to pray for Bishop Router and the people of the diocese, that we may walk together in faith and hope, guided by the Holy Spirit.

24th Sunday in Ordinary Time

13 September 2026

Let It Go!

Peter thinks forgiving seven times is generous. Jesus says seventy-seven. Which means: stop counting!

Then Jesus tells a story about a servant who owed a fortune he could never repay. He begged, and the master wiped the whole thing out. Minutes later that same servant found a man who owed him a few months' wages and took him by the throat.

Look at him closely. He has just been handed the gift of a lifetime and he cannot see it. He is so buried in his own materialism, his own rights, his own small world, that the master's mercy has not touched him at all. He walked out of that room exactly the man he walked in. Forgiven, but not free.

That is the danger for every one of us. We can receive God's mercy again and again, in confession, at the altar, and still walk out clutching the old grudge. The neighbour. The sibling. The house. The land. The job promotion. The one who let us down. The First Reading puts it bluntly: resentment is a thing we nurse, and it eats the one holding it. It narrows our vision until, like that servant, we cannot see past the debt.

Jesus ends the parable with one condition: we must forgive from the heart. Not through gritted teeth. Not a cold truce that keeps the old score sheet handy in a drawer. Forgiveness is not pretending the wrong did not matter, but it is a real letting go, deep down from where the grudge lives. And the most powerful thing is that the moment we let it go, we are the one set free. The weight lifts. We can breathe.

So this week, as you receive mercy from God, go and be mercy in action. Name it. Let it go from the heart. Then you will enjoy the freedom God's love has won for us, now and forever.

Announcements

Triduum of Masses for Bishop Michael Router As the diocese and parishes prepare to celebrate the joyous occasion of the Installation of Bishop Michael Router as Bishop of Derry on Sunday 20 September, a Triduum of Masses will be celebrated in parishes throughout the diocese, on Friday 18, Saturday 19 and Sunday 20 September. In our parishes, these Masses will be celebrated in St. Mary's Church at 10.00am on Friday 18 September; St. Theresa's Church at 10.00am on Saturday 19 September and St. Mary's Church at 11.30am on Sunday 20 September. All are welcome to attend as we come together as God's people to pray for Bishop Router and the people of the diocese, that we may walk together in faith and hope, guided by the Holy Spirit.

We welcome into God's Family through the Sacrament of Baptism

Siofra-Mai Ellen Patton

May they Rest in Peace

Deaths

Sr. Rose Ann Mulholland, St. Joseph's Convent of Mercy

Kathleen O'Hagan, Lifford

Albert O'Neill, 15 Sycamore Avenue

David Mullan, Omagh

Mickey McAleer, Woodmount Nursing Home

Anniversaries

Sonny Magee, Bridie Rouse, Mary Gormley

Donna Coulter, Hugh Gallagher, Bridget French

Agnes Walker, Tommy McGlinchey, Jimmy Coyle

Marcella Edginton, Eric Adams, Sarah McGettigan-Porter

Ellen Clarke, Clare McGonigle, Rebecca Coyle

Denis Sweeney, Patsy McElroy, Eileen McBride

Cissie Donaghey, Brian Semple, Willie Falconer

John Hegarty, Eugene Hegarty, Charlie Foley

Elizabeth Molloy, Daniel Molloy, Helen Callaghan

Noel McBride, Jim Patton

Last week's collections amounted to: **Melmount:** £3315.00; **Sion Mills:** £1135.00. Thank you.

Those who pay to the weekly collection or any special collections, including Priest's Collection by cheque are asked that all cheques should be made payable to '*Melmount Parish*' or '*Sion Mills Parish*' depending on the Parish. This is a banking requirement. *Parishioners can still leave their contributions in the Parish Office. If the Office is closed, please use the letterbox.*

Exposition of the Blessed Sacrament will take place in St. Mary's, Melmount tomorrow, Monday 14 September after 10.00am Mass until 6.30pm. The Blessed Sacrament can be adored in the Adoration Room, St. Theresa's, Sion Mills anytime while the church is open.

Collection for Retired Priests The Annual Collection for Retired Priests will be taken up at all Masses today Sunday 13 September. This is a collection to help assist priests who have retired from active ministry. There is an envelope marked '*Clergy Retirement Fund*' in your box of envelopes for this collection. Anyone contributing to this collection by cheque should make it payable to '*Melmount Parish*' or '*Sion Mills Parish*' depending on the Parish.

Vocations In today's gospel Jesus teaches a powerful lesson on forgiveness. We pray for the men called to priesthood that, as they celebrate the Sacrament of Reconciliation with their people, they will help them to know and experience the Lord who '*...is compassion and love, slow to anger, and rich in mercy.*' (Responsorial Psalm).

Parish Draw Promoters should make their returns for September to the Parish Office on **Monday 21 September from 2.00pm - 4.30pm**. The Draw for September will take place on Thursday 24 September at 10.30am in the Parish Office.

Baptism Dates Melmount

September: Saturday 19.

October: Sunday 4; Saturday 10; Saturday 17; Saturday 24.

November: Sunday 8; Saturday 14; Saturday 21; Saturday 28.

Baptisms will be at 3.30pm on a Saturday and 12.45pm on a Sunday.

The Columban Young Adults are a new group for those aged 18 – 30 in the diocese, who are seeking a community of like-minded young adults who have Christ at the centre of their lives. Our September event will be a Holy Hour and meditation on Thursday 17 September, 7.00pm at Our Lady of Lourdes Church, Steelstown, Derry, delivered by Fr. Declan McGeehan. The meditation will be followed by Solemn Benediction and light refreshments. We are actively seeking new members. Please come along and bring a friend!

Coffee Morning in aid of Foyle Hospice will be held in Murphy's on the Green on Friday 25 September from 9.30am – 12.30pm. Draw tickets £1.00 per line will be available on the day, the Draw will be held at 1.00pm.